Spring, 2003 Volume V, Issue 3

The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association
P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411



Gordon and Mary Kay Cloney are greeted by co-host Helen Pearson at the March potluck dinner, as (r) Joe Auslander talks to Paul Kagen.

Annual Meeting– New Issues, New Board Candidates Coming Soon!

We only have two months before CMA's Annual Meeting, and once again this year, we have some important issues to decide.

Chief among these is the issue of our four tennis courts.—and what can be done to repair, replace or redesign them for multiple sports use.



Jackson Bain

Marie Barrett, whose column appears later in the newsletter, has done a great job of gathering all of the options together for us to consider. Whatever you decide, remember that the tennis courts—like the pool and all other such resources on our side of Cold Run Valley Road—are a CMA amenity that has direct impact on the value of your home or property here.

We are enormously lucky to have had great leadership over the past three and half decades to build these amenities. Names you may not know—but who contributed to making our mountain neighborhood so wonderful include Charlie Barrett, Jim Bradfield, Don Fox, Lee Weinberger, Gale Connor and a dozen more. Without their willingness to pitch in ideas and energy, we would have a very different community—perhaps one you might not have chosen to live in.

But the future beckons! And we have a wonderful opportunity to create a new sports amenity for all to enjoy. What will it look like? What will it cost to build? What will it offer <u>you</u>? You'll help decide at the Annual Meeting on July 19th. You'll also pick new Board members to guide us next year. I wouldn't miss it for the world!

Jackson Bain

CMA Board Meetings and Potluck Dinners!

May 17
Board: CMA Office
1:00 p.m.
Pool Beautification Lunch!
Potluck: Bender K-3

June 14
Board: CMA Office
Potluck: Barn

July 19
Board: CMA Office
<u>ANNUAL MEETING:</u>
<u>Treetops Lodge</u>
Annual Dinner: Barn



The CMA board at work: (L-R) Joan Bradfield, Jim Chiriaco, Elmer Broxson, Paul Kagen, Marie Barrett and Richard Kaufman work through the March agenda at Richard's house.

Annual Meeting Dinner Planned

On Saturday, July 19, following the Annual Meeting, we will have our traditional Evening In the Barn. We will start at 6:30 p.m. with wine and hors d'oeurves provided by the Social Committee. (BYOB if you want something stronger.) At 7:30 p.m., a catered buffet-style dinner will be served featuring Swiss steak, roast turkey, baked ham and baked fish. Cost for the evening is $15.00 per person (over 12) children between 4 and 12 are $8.00 each. We must know by Monday, July 14 if you plan to attend so we can give a final count to the caterer. Please make checks out to CMA and send them to:

Elmer Broxson
3835 Calvert St., NW
Washington, D.C. 20007

CMA KNOWLEDGE CENTRAL

Editor's note: We have two special features in a row from one of our esteemed resident professors, Elmer Broxson. Last issue, Elmer wrote on the wildlife on our mountainside. This time, Elmer puts on his hat as CMA's Certified Water Operator (and a VERY fine and fancy hat it is!) This feature is our "Knowledge Central" for the newsletter, and we look forward to receiving submissions from all other members who can keep our understanding of this community, its history, its environment, and the region around us up to date. Please send your ideas to Jackson Bain- (jackson@bainpr.com) Here is Elmer's report:

West Virginia Water Writes - An Update on Supply, Demand and Ownership

By Elmer Broxson



The effort by the West Virginia-American Water Company (WV-AWC) last fall to buy or manage the Berkeley Springs water works is only a small part of a much larger process taking place not only in west Virginia and the United States, but around the world. We are seeing a change from a system in which the right of access to water is free to one in which water is bought and sold in the market like any other commodity. It becomes a property right that can legally be separated from ownership of the land.

A recent editorial in the "Morgan Messenger" (2/19/03) signals an increasing awareness in West Virginia of this issue. This change is given greater immediacy by a call for a state government study and a quote from a State Senator, who compares this trend with the 19th century coal barons who bought up the mineral rights from local land owners. During 2002, WV-AWC expanded its water system ownership to one third of the counties in the state. It is active in over 25 states, and along with other water companies such as Vivendi Universal, the trend is growing in at least 10 countries.

This spring, the advocacy group Public citizen has undertaken a nationwide campain o oppose the privatization of water systems and supplies. According to the West Virginia Geological Survey, the state's 60 large, uncontaminated springs produce about 84 million gallons of high quality water each day. The issue is who will have access to and profit from this increasingly valuable resource.

Where Does Our Water Come From, Anyway?

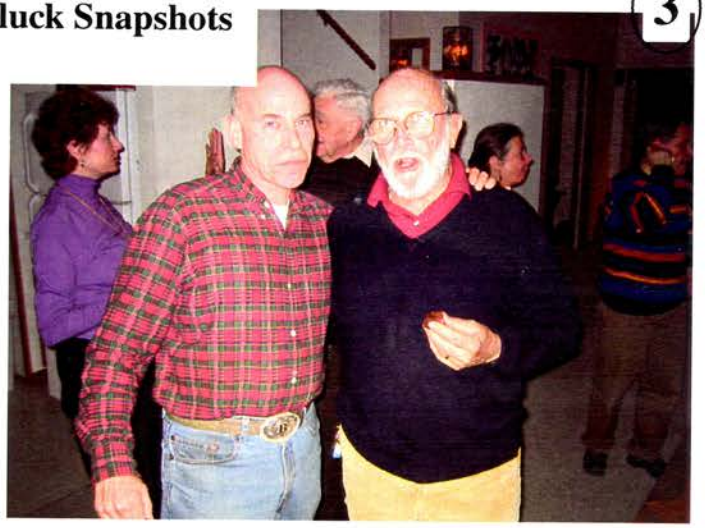
By Jackson Bain

The issues raised by Elmer Broxson above are ones we all need to consider as we collectively plan for the future of CMA. Our water comes from a fine, high quality aquifer that is part of a much larger region of aquifers called the Valley and Ridge province, which runs from Northern Pennsylvania all the way to Alabama. The water in much of this aquifer region fell as rain years ago, and has been filtered through the carbonate rock before it reaches the water level drawn by our two wells - the South Well and the North Well. Our community's water is so good that it placed among the top five small community waters in the nation in a competition a few years ago in New York City. Our water supply levels in those wells is high currently— we measure those levels at the same time we read the CMA water meters for billing. But we know that additional wells—installed by developers along Cold Run valley and even beyond Warm Springs ridge to our East, can have a serious effect on both the quantity and quality of water from this aquifer. We must remain aware and - no other word will do - vigilant, to protect this most vital of all CMA's vital resources from exploitation.

CMA March Potluck Snapshots



Co-hosts Helen Pearson and Sherry Rubin place the latest delicious cuisine on the groaning board. More than 25 people attended and brought great Potluck dishes to sample!



The irrepressible Charlie Balkan chats with Carroll Yingling, while Sandy Bain and Harry Birnkrant (background) dicuss the food. Barbara Meeker and Richard Kaufman (right) tour the lovely home of Glenn and Helen Pearson and Sherry Rubin.

The President's Column



Richard Kaufman

We Live in a Forest

Our mountainside community is, when you get right down to it, a forest. Officially, we are defined as a "Wild Land – Urban Interface," according to the West Virginia Division of Forestry. Despite the inelegant label, we like dwelling among the trees and shrubs, and the squirrels and chipmunks, and the wild turkeys, woodpeckers and song birds, and the Luna moths, and even the snakes and the occasional bear - as long as they don't get too close.

The Division of Forestry is in the process of sending a message to us urban interfacers and it does have a point. Those who live where the wild life live have to take care to, among other things, reduce the risk of forest fires. Towards this worthy end, the division has begun to develop a "Firewise" educational program for communities like ours. The full program will be announced, I am told, in the fall. Meanwhile, the division has issued a check list of fire prevention safety precautions.

Most items in the Firewise list are common sense. But that does not mean they have occurred to all of us. In any event, a few words to the firewise should be sufficient and it is good to be reminded to:

- remove leaf clutter and dead overhanging branches that are close to the house;
- keep gutters, eaves and roofs clear of leaves and other debris;
- clear your property of dead wood and dense vegetation near the house;
- store firewood away from the house and from decks;
- leave an area around the house to accommodate fire equipment.

The list also contains many recommendations for homebuilders and those adding structures such as decks and porches. For example, fire-resistant materials should be used whenever possible. There should be at least 2 ground level exits from the house and 2 means of escape from each room. Make occasional inspections of your home to detect deterioration such as warping wood, or cracks and crevices in the structure. A protective barrier of masonry or metal should be installed between the house and a deck or porch.

The full list from the Division of Forestry will be made available to CMA members.

Richard F. Kaufman

Social and Communications Committee: Big Finish for a Great Year

By Joan Bradfield and Hallie Kerr, Co-Chairs



Joan Bradfield

The monthly Board meeting will be held Saturday, May 17th at 10 AM in the CMA office.

At approximately 1 PM Lunch will be served in the office for all those who will be helping with the annual pool/tennis courts clean up day. Won't you join us-at least for a little while?

At 6:30 PM the potluck will be held at Flo Bender's home-Villa Firenze, K-3.

It's a busy weekend and we look forward to seeing many of you there-last Board meeting there were 15 CMA members present at various times during the meeting!

I have attached the latest updated directory changes-we get a new one in July. And to that end, I have attached a directory form should you have any changes to you listing. Please copy it and either send it back to me or to Marge Gordon at grizzly2@intrepid.net.

POOL BEAUTIFICATION DAY

Please join us for our annual pool and tennis court beautification on Saturday, May 17th. A FREE lunch will be served in the office (near the pool) at approximately 1 p.m., following the board meeting. Cleanup and planting will begin around 2 p.m. Bring a rake, shovel or spade, and your work gloves!

Coolfont Mountainside Association

From the Treasurer: Down the Homestretch for CMA Finances

By Paul Kagen

It's budget preparation time. As I sit here working on the CMA budget for the next fiscal year I have been faced with the most difficult task of shoehorning two major capital projects, each costing in the neighborhood of $50,000, into next year's budget. You may be aware that the board is faced with proposals to repair and upgrade our roads and within the same budget a proposal to upgrade our tennis facilities. Each of these proposals, by itself, can be accommodated in next year's budget without any change in the annual assessment levels. However, to do both in the same year will require us to draw upon our reserves or borrow the needed capital or provide for a special assessment. Our reserves are large enough to cover the cost if that is the decision. As we meet to discuss the two proposals and arrive at our recommendation to the members at the annual meeting, I am sure each of the members of the board would welcome any suggestions, advice or opinions as to the action to be taken. I feel sure these projects will be fully discussed both at the Board and at the annual meeting.



Paul Kagen

At the three quarter point in our fiscal year the financial condition of CMA is in great shape, as is that of the CMA Water and Sewer system.

With regard to the CMA budget, I can report that one assessment remains unpaid and through April we have received over 101% of the income budgeted for the year. Our expenses have been well controlled in all areas of the budget. I anticipate that all expense budget items will end the year either under budget or within a reasonable range. The cash position of the Association remains strong.

With regard to the Water and Sewer budget, I can report that in the 10 months through April we have collected 80% of our annual income budget and we have spent 77% of our budget. As you are aware, the last Water and Sewer bills were estimated because of the monstrous snows of late February. We will again read the meters this month and having a record of actual usage credits will be given for overestimates and any underestimates will be billed. Most of the estimates should have been close since they were based upon past usage, however there will be cases where adjustments will be large.

I want to thank those members who make my job a pleasure by paying their assessments and water bills in a timely manner. I am concerned that after each quarter's water bill is rendered, approximately 10-20 members do not pay on time. Not only does it cost them a 10% penalty, but it makes the job of the volunteer Treasurer more time consuming. Even though only 20 days are allowed for timely payment (a rule imposed on us by the Public Service Commission of West Virginia), I urge each of you to pay promptly, thereby avoiding the penalty and making my job easier.

As always, I am ready to respond to any questions you may have about the financial condition of the Association or its Water and Sewer system.

New Swimming Pool Passes and Rules Sent to Members

By Marie Barrett, Recreation Chair



Marie Barrett

SWIMMING POOL NEWS

Swimming pool passes and the pool season schedule and rules were mailed out to members in May. The package includes a list of pool regulations mandated by the West Virginia Bureau for Public Health. To help us stay in compliance with state regulations, we have upgraded the pool filtration systems and hired a company to assist in managing our pool this year.

The CMA board gave some consideration to changing the swimming pool hours. We made one small change -- the pool will be open until 5 p.m. on Sundays, instead of 4 p.m. This year's sign-in sheet will have an additional block for time of arrival. That will give us some data to use in possibly adjusting the pool hours next year.

TENNIS COURTS

The board is pursuing options for fixing up one or more of our tennis courts. We will include our recommendations in the materials to be mailed out for the annual meeting in July.

Development and Architectural Control Committee (DACC)
By Jim Thompson, DACC Chair



Due to the harsh winter, a number of homeowners have experienced roof leakage and deck damage. It would be a good idea to look for signs of leaks and determine if repairs are required. If so, please contact me about getting DACC approval for the repairs.

Apparently some members have been re-painting or re-staining their homes – sometimes with significantly different colors – without notifying DACC. You are required to contact DACC when making any repairs or re-painting.

A number of projects are proceeding at a significant pace. For new construction, houses are now substantially complete at A-2, H-1 and Q-7 and progress continues with K-1, K-2 and T-8. A number of repair and modification projects have been approved recently.

Planning construction or an improvement? Contact: Jim Thompson
DACC Chair
2748 S. Grove St.
Arlington, VA 22202-2424
703-684-8465





How's Your Road and Driveway? Report from the Roads Committee
By Jim Chiriaco, CMA Board Member

The Roads Committee

On May 5, 2003, an inspection of every road in the Coolfont Mountainside Association was conducted. The results revealed that a majority of the concerns are related to road maintenance. The Committee is preparing a report for the Board at the next meeting. The priorities that have been identified, include: enlarging the pipe size in culverts, cleaning culverts and catch basins, repairing and building headwalls, pulling ditches along the sides of the roads, in some cases, installing rip-rap, planting grass in the ditches, re-grading the roads, fixing the pot holes, and installing swales (ditches) in some areas. The Committee is working on a plan to address these concerns.

EMS Addresses

We are working with Morgan County to obtain an official EMS address for all homes in the Coolfont Mountainside Association. We have obtained a preliminary list and are working to make corrections and updates. We intend to distribute a report by the Annual Meeting. We are also working on a plan to have new signs for street names and numbers. The EMS identification system is designed to allow the fire and rescue departments to properly identify our homes in case of an emergency, so the can respond efficiently and effectively.

CORRECTIONS TO THE CMA 2002-2003 DIRECTORY

Add for I-4
James Applebaum & Laurie Mufson
300 E. Seminary Street
Mercersburg, PA 17236
717-328-2471

Remove Coolfont Development Corp.

Marie Barrett-new home E-mail address:
Mbarrett@mybluelight.com

Michael Barrett-E-mail address: mbarrett@liuna.org

Mark Borinsky-E-mail address:
mborinsk@jhmi.edu

Remove Bowers

Add for Lot E-3:
Ramona Branscone
6575 Forest Dew Court
Springfield, VA 22152
Home phone: 703-569-5471
Office phone: 703-284-7670

Add for Q-1 & Q-2:
Charles & Laura Braun
4030 Chancery Ct, NW
Washington, DC 20007

Elmer Broxson-add e-mail: Tbroxson@yahoo.com

Remove Ethan Burger & Neva Grant

Add for Q-4:
Dennis & Evelyn Brydges
2 Coolfont
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
Coolfont phone: 304 258-0146
(Winter address or when not on Mountainside)
10 Deerfield CT., Palm Coast, FL 32137
Florida phone: 904-445-2408
Cell phone: 703-731-4305
email: dennybrydges@aol.com
EOBrydges@aol.com

Remove Sherry & Don Cameron

Remove Evelyn Cate

Remove Travis Clark

New address for the Corbeys
604 Mannakee St.
Rockville, MD 20850
Change Harry Deutsch to "The Estate of Harry Deutsch"

Add for P-1
Andrew & Maryann Fialdini
11963 Grey Squirrel Lane
Reston, VA 20194
703-318-0127
E-mail: amfialdini@comcast.net
and
Craig & Kim Garten
1634 Autumnwood Drive
Reston, VA 20194
703-481-1534 E-mail: customblt@aol.com

Add for G-6
Darryl & Marcia Friedman
44157 Tippecanoe Terrace
Ashburn, VA 20147
Home phone: 703-723-3231
E-mail: Marcia@steadyquill.com
and
Sandra Thompson
4807 Wilby Court
Alexandria, VA 22310
Home phone: 703-971-2740
E-mail: ThompsonSa@usa.redcross.org

Remove Stan & Susan Gordon

Remove Arleigh Greenblatt

Add for Q-7:
Ed & Joan Haywood
7 Ridgecliff Court
Kingsville, MD 21087
Home telephone: 410-592-7744
Work telephone: 410-935-7665
Work FAX 1-866-422-1885
E-mail: ed@edhaywood.com

New address for Harald & Joanne Herp
53A Crescent Rd # 107, Greenbelt, MD 20770

Richard Kaufman-new E-mail address:
RFKaufman@MSN.com

New address for the Kasemans
20500 Top Ridge Drive
Boyds, MD 20841
Home phone: 301-972-2455

Add E-mail for Hallie Kerr:
hopesprings132@aol.com

Add for N-6:
Terry & Marsha Moore
1346 Washington Dr.
Annapolis, MD 21403
Home phone: 410-263-4503
E-mail: TMoore9261@aol.com

Bob & Maureen Newberg
Home phone: 301-926-6123 E-mail address:
BOB64GTO@aol.com

Add for Q-3:
Denzil & Marilyn Pritchard
2357 Bell Branch Rd.
Gambrills, MD 21054
phone 301-261-6187

Remove David Silver & Anne Schwartz

Kathy Steinberg-E-mail address:
Knewman@umm.edu

D-7 New name & address:
Gini Sweet Temple
P.O. Box 1576,
Ashburn, VA 20146
Work phone: 703-771-6570,
Coolfont phone: 304-258-7901

Ken Sachs & Judy Grasso-E-mail address:
kfsachs@comcast.net

Add for lot E-4:
Ronald & Myna Wohl
14501 Antigone Dr
North Potomac, MD 20872
Home phone: 301-340-2821

Add for T-6:
Andrew & Joan Zuckerman
8611 Timber Hill Lane
Potomac, MD 20854
Home phone: 301 299-6965
Work phone: 301-452-3508

Don't Just Sit There!
VOLUNTEER
For Something!

There is great fun and there are great friendships in CMA—but our community needs your ideas and energy, as a volunteer. Ask your nearest board member how you can help! (That's why we print their photos!)

